STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE			G-6214
	SARPY COUNTY SHERIFF'S OFFICE PAPILLION * NEBRASKA **GREG LONDON** **SHERIFF**	DATE ISSUED 12/04/06	DATE REVISED **06/15/21**	DATE REVIEWED 02/02/25
		APPROVED: *GREG LONDON*		
CHAPTER TITLE GENERAL	RESOURCES NRS 28-1412			
SUBJECT SEMI-AUTOMATIC CARBINE	CROSS REFERENCE G-6100 USE OF FORCE G-8100 TRAINING REQUESTS AND ATTENDANCE G-8300 FIREARMS TRAINING AND QUALIFICATION			

I. Purpose:

The purpose of this policy is to establish the guidelines for carrying and using semi-automatic carbines.

II. Policy:

Sarpy County Sheriff's Office personnel are authorized to carry and use only those firearms that conform to the specifications and requirements set forth in policy. Rules pertaining to the use of firearms are contained in G-6100 Use of Force and in each authorized weapon policy. The authority to carry and use firearms for sworn personnel in the performance of duty is established in NRS 28-1412. No deputy shall carry or use any firearm he or she is not authorized to carry or use nor shall any employee carry or use any firearm he or she is not trained to use.

Deputies may be allowed to carry an approved semi-automatic carbine. Carbines may be provided by the Sheriff's Office or privately owned by an individual. Deputies may receive reimbursement for their carbines in accordance with the authorized uniform and equipment list.

III. Definitions:

A. LEAD CARBINE INSTRUCTOR: The Sheriff shall appoint a command officer as the Lead Carbine Instructor. The Lead Carbine Instructor shall be a certified firearms and carbine instructor and shall function as the liaison between the command staff and the carbine instructors. The Lead Carbine Instructor shall assist the carbine instructors in the administration of firearms training and shall be responsible for the carbine program. The Lead Carbine Instructor shall be responsible for approving personally owned carbines and carbine related equipment.

B. LEAD CARBINE ARMORER: The Sheriff shall appoint a deputy as the Lead Carbine Armorer. The Lead Carbine Armorer shall be a certified firearms and carbine instructor and a certified carbine armorer. The Lead Carbine Armorer shall be responsible for the maintenance of all sheriff's office carbines. The Lead Carbine Armorer shall consult with the Lead Carbine Instructor regarding authorized carbines and related equipment. The Lead Carbine Armorer shall assist the Lead Carbine Instructor in the administration of firearms training.

IV. Procedures:

A. Semi-Automatic Carbine Requirements:

1. **Caliber:** Semi-automatic carbines shall be chambered in .223 Remington/5.56mm.

2. **Brand:** Semi-automatic carbines shall be an AR-15/M4 style manufactured by a reputable manufacturer as approved by the Lead Carbine Instructor.

3. **Barrel Length:** Carbines shall have a barrel length legal under federal guidelines.

4. **Capacity:** Carbines shall have magazines manufactured by a reputable manufacturer as approved by the Lead Carbine Instructor. Magazines should be loaded two (2) rounds less than capacity to ensure reliable feeding of rounds.

5. **Color:** Authorized semiautomatic carbines shall be factory blued, black, or stainless in color.

6. **Personal Carbine Request to Carry:** Any deputy requesting to carry a private carbine shall fill out a Personal Carbine Request to Carry form. This form will detail the review, inspection, approval, and registration process.

7. **Training:**

   a) Deputies shall complete the basic carbine training course taught by a certified carbine instructor with a minimum qualifying score or have attended the carbine course at the Training Academy in Grand Island or SDLEA and maintained their certification prior to carrying a semi-automatic carbine.

      (1) Deputies wishing to carry a carbine on duty shall submit a training request to attend the basic carbine training course.

Each training request shall be reviewed individually by the command staff (see G-8100 Training Requests and Attendance).

(2) Deputies attending the rifle course through the training academy may maintain their certification with a department rifle at the annual department qualifier.

b) Deputies must also maintain a minimum qualifying score on all required carbine qualification courses (see G-8300 Firearms Training and Qualification) in order to continue to carry a carbine. A minimum qualifying score shall be 80%.

c) Deputies authorized to carry a carbine shall be provided training ammunition for each qualification shoot.

d) Deputies authorized to carry a carbine and who maintain their currency shall be provided fifty (50) rounds of carbine duty ammunition. If a deputy elects to no longer maintain his or her currency, then the fifty (50) rounds of issued duty ammunition shall be returned to the department.

e) A make-up shoot shall be held for deputies with an excused absence.

f) Deputies that miss a qualification and a make-up shoot shall not be permitted to carry or use any carbine in an official capacity until he or she successfully completes the next department sponsored qualification shoot.

g) Deputies assigned a Sheriff's office carbine that miss qualification and make- up shoot must turn in their carbine to the Lead Carbine Instructor.

B. Semi-Automatic Carbine Carry/Storage:

1. Deputies certified to carry a carbine, shall have their carbine available at all times when on duty.

2. Carbines shall be transported in the trunk of the deputy's assigned Sheriff's Office vehicle unless his or her vehicle is equipped with a rack.

3. If carried in the trunk, the carbine shall be carried in a hard case, chamber empty, bolt forward, hammer down, and dust cover closed. A magazine may be installed in the carbine, if the case permits.

4. If the deputy's patrol unit is equipped with a rack, the carbine shall be secured in the rack with the chamber empty (as described in 3 above) and with a magazine installed in the carbine. The rack shall remain locked at all times unless the carbine is being removed for use or transport.

5. When off-duty, the carbine shall be stored in the arms room in its case, in the deputy's personal vehicle, or in the deputy's home. If the deputy is assigned Sheriff's Office vehicle, the carbine may be secured in the trunk, in its case, or if available, the carbine may be left secured in the patrol unit carbine rack in the passenger compartment. Each deputy is solely responsible for security of his or her carbine.

6. SRO Office Storage:

a) SRO's shall have the option of storing a department issued or personal carbine in their office with approval from the school district in which they work

b) Gun safes used to store department issued or personal carbines inside a school shall be approved by the Road Patrol Commander prior to use. Only the SRO assigned to that school and the Special Services Unit Supervisor shall have access to that particular gun safe. Access to the SRO office will also be restricted as much as possible in partnership with the school district.

c) Carbines stored inside a school by an SRO shall remain secured in the safe at all times unless being removed for deployment or transport.

d) Carbines stored inside a school by an SRO may be left overnight during consecutive school days. When school is off for one or more days, or the SRO will be gone for one or more days, the carbine shall be removed from the office and secured in the SRO's assigned cruiser, the SRO's personal vehicle, or in the SRO's home.

C. **Use of Semi-Automatic Carbine (Non-Uniform Deputies):** Deputies wearing civilian clothing shall not use a carbine in a law enforcement situation without being readily identifiable as a deputy. Readily identifiable shall mean easily recognized from the front and rear by wearing clothing with the word "Sheriff" in large visible lettering. Acceptable clothing includes:

1. A tactical vest cover or external assault shell (EAS) with the word "Sheriff" clearly visible on the front and back in at least two (2) inch letters.

2. A hidden agenda style jacket with front and rear identification panels exposed.

3. Other clothing items may be approved by a deputy's division commander, but shall cover the torso and have "Sheriff" clearly visible in at least two (2) inch letters.

D. **Semi-Automatic Carbine Accessories:** No accessories may be added to or modifications made to any semi-automatic carbine without being inspected by Lead Carbine Armorer and approved by the Lead Carbine Instructor. To request a modification to a carbine or to request the addition of an accessory, the deputy shall complete a Carbine Modification Request form. Accessories for privately owned carbines may be purchased with uniform allowance according to Authorized Uniform and Equipment list. Any questions on Rifle/Accessory reimbursement or modifications to a Sheriff's owned carbine should be directed to the Lead Carbine Instructor or Lead Carbine Armorer for approval.

1. Carbines shall be equipped with a sling.

2. Approved Accessories: The following accessories may be added without the completion of a Carbine Modification Request form. All other accessories must be inspected and approved prior to duty carry.

a) Redi-Mag magazine holder.
b) Night sights.
c) Hard case to replace original.
d) Grip
e) Handguard
f) Flip up sight
g) Reddot Sight
h) Sling/mount
i) Flashlight/mount
j) Flashhider
k) Collapsible stock
l) Magazines
m) BAD Levers
n) Charging Handles

3. Electronic sights may be approved for carbines under the following conditions:

a) The electronic sight may only be an Eotech, Aimpoint,Trijicon MRO, Vortex SPARC, Vortex SPARC II, or Vortex Strikefire II. Deputy requesting any additional manufacturers must submit the request in

writing to the Lead Carbine Instructor. Sights must have no magnification (i.e. 1x magnification). Telescopic sights will not be authorized.

b) The deputy shall complete a Carbine Modification Request form. The electronic sight must be inspected by the Lead Carbine Armorer and approved by the Lead Carbine Instructor.

c) Deputies employing an electronic sight may be required to fire one or two rounds prior to scheduled qualifications, and may be required to attend additional qualifications to ensure the electronic sights have remained accurate. A deputy employing an electronic sight who misses pre-qualification shots shall remove the electronic sight and may not re-install the sight until the next scheduled qualification.

d) Deputies employing an electronic sight must also have iron sights immediately available and must qualify with both sighting systems at regularly scheduled qualifications.

e) The Lead Carbine Instructor shall have the final decision on whether a deputy is allowed to mount or maintain an electronic sight.